

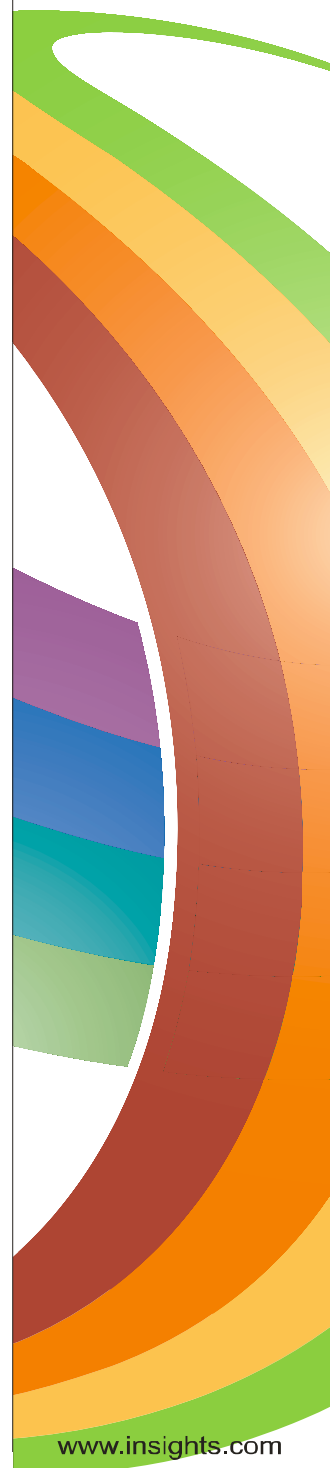


Discovery Insights®

Sean Porter
10/24/2014

Personal Profile

Foundation Chapter
Management Chapter



Personal Details

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Introduction

This Insights Discovery profile is based on Sean Porter's responses to the Insights Preference Evaluator which was completed on 10/24/2014.

The origins of personality theory can be traced back to the fifth century BC, when Hippocrates identified four distinct energies exhibited by different people. The Insights System is built around the model of personality first identified by the Swiss psychologist Carl Gustav Jung. This model was published in his 1921 work "Psychological Types" and developed in subsequent writings. Jung's work on personality and preferences has since been adopted as the seminal work in understanding personality and has been the subject of study for thousands of researchers to the present day.

Using Jung's typology, this Insights Discovery profile offers a framework for self-understanding and development. Research suggests that a good understanding of self, both strengths and weaknesses, enables individuals to develop effective strategies for interaction and can help them to better respond to the demands of their environment.

Generated from several hundred thousand permutations of statements, this profile is unique. It reports statements which your Evaluator responses indicate may apply to you. Modify or delete any statement which does not apply, but only after checking with colleagues or friends to identify whether the statement may be a "blind spot" for you.

Use this profile pro-actively. That is, identify the key areas in which you can develop and take action. Share the important aspects with friends and colleagues. Ask for feedback from them on areas which seem particularly relevant for you and develop an action plan for growth personally and interpersonally.

Overview

These statements provide a broad understanding of Sean's work style. Use this section to gain a better understanding of his approaches to his activities, relationships and decisions.

Personal Style

Sean is logical and analytical, an ingenious thinker and long-range planner, and good at anything that requires rapid reasoning. He dislikes confusion, inefficiency, half measures and anything that he sees as aimless or ineffective. He is a disciplinarian who can be tough when the situation calls for it. He is adept at dealing with crisis situations and will readily take charge, organise and communicate to others a sense of calm, security and confidence. Once a desired objective is fixed in his mind, he moves into action without procrastinating. He is a natural manager and finds himself in command through his ability to plan and keep both long and short-term objectives clearly in mind.

He is often more interested in “real things” than intangibles, such as abstract ideas and theories. He is alert to what is happening around him and concerned primarily with the here and now. He sees himself as having rigorous standards that typically take precedence over his own and others' personal needs. He may in reality be less competent at a specific task than his confident style indicates. Sean is independent by nature, but he is prepared to labour tirelessly for a team mission he commits to.

Seen as a “natural” leader, he wants to have a significant impact on the lives of others and may resort to dictatorial practices if anything appears to get in the way. At his best, he is responsible, industrious, decisive and energetic. He has a drive for tangible accomplishment and correctness with a leaning towards perfection. He likes to make sure that he knows what is going on and tries to make sure that everyone is pulling their weight. Sean is hardworking, righteous, fiercely independent and convinced that moral good must win above all else. He is convinced that a successful life needs to be tough and that satisfaction must be earned and re-earned.

Developing, fostering, improving and honing his skills is likely to be a life's work for him. He feels more secure when he can control a situation by ensuring other people conform to his thinking. Sean is an adaptable realist, relying on what he sees, hears and knows for himself. People with whom Sean works are aware of his excellent organisational qualities and commercial aptitude. Sean's ability to focus on task suggests that he is a good problem solver.

He is keen to pick out logical inconsistencies. He enjoys getting things done - sometimes at the expense of others! Hard work, busy schedules and merit-based remuneration are hallmarks of the way Sean prefers to work. At work he often makes significantly more starts than finishes and he

may need someone else to follow through with the details. When he allows feelings to go ignored or unexpressed, he can eventually overreact emotionally to difficult interpersonal challenges.

Interacting with Others

Being respected by his peers is of greater importance to Sean than being liked. He has a tendency to blame other people for difficulties he encounters and may sometimes dismiss others' opinions as of relatively little or no value. He might confess to being puzzled by others' perception of him as rigid and intractable. This perception may result from his tendency to express his independent views rather directly. Much of his true style may be hidden from others at work as he is unlikely to express his feelings until he knows someone well. He may need to work at taking the feelings of others into account and to learn to express his appreciation of others more readily.

He does not appreciate critical comments about his personal qualities as he sees these comments as personal attacks on his integrity. Frequently reflecting, his intuitive feelings prompt a sense of the endless possibilities inherent within him as he considers how such potential may be realised. He is not particularly discouraged by indifference or criticism. He may prefer not, or may find it difficult, to express personal feelings to others. He needs to learn to appreciate the “illogical” feelings of others and to accept that they are also valid.

Although Sean may protest about the pressure of attending family events, it would seldom occur to him not to be present, as these occasions are important to him. Although his emotional and social life may not seem as important to him as other aspects of life, he tends to seek consistent and stable relationships. He could learn to express his appreciation of other people regularly and may find it useful to listen more and appreciate how others really feel. Sean can turn his talents to many jobs, but finds more satisfaction from work that allows him to use his creativity and interpersonal skills. He can be somewhat inconsiderate towards both himself and others, and tends to drive others almost as hard as he drives himself.

Decision Making

Sean is willing to admit the truth about people or things that are important to him, is very alert to problems, and seeks to find solutions himself. Sean is extremely realistic and relies on and trusts what his senses tell him about his world. He may appear dismissive of decisions made on “gut-feel” rather than objective analysis. He has a tendency towards making higher risk decisions. Sean is self-reliant and is not frightened to take “the path of maximum resistance” in his efforts to produce the best results.

Politically aware, Sean is normally comfortable with his decisions even in the face of possible conflict with others in more senior positions. In decision-making he may prefer to apologise for exceeding his authority rather than getting permission in the first place. He may occasionally see

himself as being physically larger than life, especially during confrontation. He is frank and decisive and doesn't hesitate to let others know where he stands. Sean is seen by many as a natural leader and decision maker. Sean's tendency to think “out loud” enables others to follow his line of thinking.

He prefers action to conversation and enjoys dealing with difficult situations the moment they arise. “Do it now” is his motto. He tends to be influenced by the idea, rather than the people behind the idea. If something does not seem rational, he runs the risk of dismissing it out of hand, even if it is a critical issue. In his mind there must always be a good reason for doing something and people's feelings alone aren't normally sufficient to influence him.

Personal Notes

Key Strengths & Weaknesses

Strengths

This section identifies the key strengths which Sean brings to the organisation. Sean has abilities, skills and attributes in other areas, but the statements below are likely to be some of the fundamental gifts he has to offer.

Sean's key strengths:

-  Evaluates people on their results.
-  Change agent.
-  Embraces change readily.
-  Effective and efficient time manager.
-  Competitive and wants to win at all costs.
-  Articulate and competitive self starter.
-  Sensible and matter of fact.
-  Confident and forthright.
-  Realistic, adaptable and pragmatic problem solver.
-  Ingenious thinker with a great ability in long range planning.

Personal Notes

Key Strengths & Weaknesses

Possible Weaknesses

Jung said “wisdom accepts that all things have two sides”. It has also been said that a weakness is simply an overused strength. Sean's responses to the Evaluator have suggested these areas as possible weaknesses.

Sean's possible weaknesses:

-  Usually puts facts before feelings.
-  Sometimes lacks a sense of humour.
-  His confidence can sometimes be interpreted as arrogance.
-  May appear abrupt.
-  Will lose interest quickly if the challenge diminishes.
-  May appear cold and unfeeling.
-  May step on the toes of others to achieve objectives.
-  May neglect family, friends and time for personal relaxation.
-  Exhibits impatience with disorganised individuals.
-  Appears to be critical of or to de-value the work of others.

Personal Notes

Value to the Team

Each person brings a unique set of gifts, attributes and expectations to the environment in which they operate. Add to this list any other experiences, skills or other attributes which Sean brings, and make the most important items on the list available to other team members.

As a team member, Sean:

-  Contributes vigorously and energetically.
-  May lose the battle, but rarely concedes defeat.
-  Keeps others on track.
-  Will cut through “red tape” to speed up the outcome.
-  Encourages down to earth realism.
-  Demonstrates leadership and involvement.
-  Likes being in the thick of the action.
-  Considers the practicalities of any issue.
-  Responds well to immediate challenges.
-  Brings direction and realism to every project.

Personal Notes

Communication

Effective Communications

Communication can only be effective if it is received and understood by the recipient. For each person certain communication strategies are more effective than others. This section identifies some of the key strategies which will lead to effective communication with Sean. Identify the most important statements and make them available to colleagues.

Strategies for communicating with Sean:

-  Agree with him wherever possible.
-  Be well structured and organised.
-  Look for signs that say “I’m losing interest”.
-  Give him verifiable facts.
-  Appeal to his open style of decision making.
-  Be sure he sees evidence of your support.
-  Be thorough, organised and on time.
-  Be ready to ignore his seemingly arrogant demeanour.
-  Leave personalities out of the discussion.
-  Respect his values and ambition.
-  Present only solid and reliable facts.
-  Be practical, realistic and direct.

Personal Notes

Communication

Barriers to Effective Communication

Certain strategies will be less effective when communicating with Sean. Some of the things to be avoided are listed below. This information can be used to develop powerful, effective and mutually acceptable communication strategies.

When communicating with Sean, DO NOT:

-  Tell him what to do or how to do it.
-  Keep him in the dark or he will do likewise.
-  Leap between topics in an unstructured way.
-  Appear slow or unambitious.
-  “Steal his thunder”.
-  Undermine his authority.
-  Come unprepared and disorganised.
-  Challenge his perception of himself.
-  Be messy, unstructured or ill-equipped.
-  Offer opinions on personal issues unless he asks for them.
-  Show disagreement with or disrespect for his principles.
-  Challenge his authority “head on”.

Personal Notes

Possible Blind Spots

Our perceptions of self may be different to the perceptions others have of us. We project who we are onto the outside world through our “persona” and are not always aware of the effect our less conscious behaviours have on others. These less conscious behaviours are termed “Blind Spots”. Highlight the important statements in this section of which you are unaware and test them for validity by asking for feedback from friends or colleagues.

Sean’s possible Blind Spots:

Sean is often very forward and intense and may not re-adjust this intensity to meet the more moderate needs of some situations. As a forthright, results oriented individual, he will challenge authority, take risks, overstep boundaries and act without reference. He may appear to some as snobbish, giving the impression that he is intellectually superior to those he believes are below” himself. Sometimes he is so intent on his own plans that he doesn't stop to listen to what others have to say. Since he is a natural critic, he tends not to demonstrate his appreciation of the positive attributes or contributions of those around him.

He tells rather than asks, and whilst confident in communicating, can be rather overpowering at times. There is also a tendency for him to become very defensive if challenged. He may have difficulty accepting what others have to say if it varies from his own certainties. As he doesn't naturally ask “what if”, he often misses possible meanings, implications and connections. He may rely on personal forcefulness and, if necessary, intimidation to achieve his aims. He may adopt an “if you've got a headache take an aspirin” attitude, which indicates a lack of empathy to some.

Particularly dependable if things are going his way, he will resent being told what to do or how to do things better. He needs to look beyond the current moment and his pressing interest in the practical world and consider ways of completing tasks with less pressure. He may appear aggressive and too strong willed at times.

Personal Notes

Opposite Type

The description in this section is based on Sean's opposite type on the Insights Wheel. Often, we have most difficulty understanding and interacting with those whose preferences are different to our own. Recognising these characteristics can help in developing strategies for personal growth and enhanced interpersonal effectiveness.

Recognising your Opposite Type:

Sean's opposite Insights type is the Supporter, Jung's "Introverted Feeling" type.

Supporters are affable, amiable, steady, loyal individuals who get on well with others. They build a close relationship with a small group of associates in the work environment. Sean will see the Supporter's efforts being directed at retaining the familiar and predictable. Supporters look for constant appreciation from others and may be slow to adapt to change. They will often go the "extra mile" to help someone they consider as a friend.

Sean may suspect the Supporter requires assistance in eliminating the old and embracing the new. Supporters are cautious, conventional, diplomatic and sincere and may avoid decision making until many of the facts and details are available to them. The Supporter is intent on maintaining a low profile. In order to perform well, the Supporter needs specific and detailed instructions before starting a job.

Sean will experience frustration when the Supporter, if challenged, becomes stubborn and defiant. Supporters are easy going and low key people and like to feel needed and significant in other peoples' lives. Even if a mistake has been made by someone else the Supporter may spend a lot of time sympathising and attempting to diffuse responsibility. Disagreements or opposing views can be stressful to Supporters. If the conflict in the workplace becomes too great they may become restless and uneasy, often withdrawing to avoid further conflict.

Personal Notes

Opposite Type

Communication with Sean's Opposite Type

Written specifically for Sean, this section suggests some strategies he could use for effective interaction with someone who is his opposite type on the Insights Wheel.

Sean Porter: How you can meet the needs of your Opposite Type:

-  Remember to ask for his opinions of other systems and projects.
-  Be careful to maintain the status quo.
-  Allow time for him to respond to your requests and questions.
-  Help him feel at ease.
-  Maintain a consistent, personal relationship with him.
-  Remember and respect his concern for others' welfare.

Sean Porter: When dealing with your opposite type DO NOT:

-  Force him to take a positive stance on an issue without time for thought.
-  Ignore his personal values.
-  Assume he knows he has chosen well.
-  Assume passivity is tacit acceptance.
-  Invade his personal space.
-  Force quick decisions where other people are affected.

Personal Notes

Suggestions for Development

Insights Discovery does not offer direct measures of skill, intelligence, education or training. However, listed below are some suggestions for Sean's development. Identify the most important areas which have not yet been addressed. These can then be incorporated into a personal development plan.

Sean may benefit from:

-  Looking for the good in everything.
-  Learning how to relax completely.
-  Being less forthright and more discreet.
-  Slowing down.
-  Trying to hear and appreciate others' perspectives.
-  Controlling his occasional moments of anger.
-  Constant reminding of the need to consider alternatives and anticipate consequences.
-  Avoiding driving others as hard as he drives himself.
-  Arguing the opposing position to recognise the value of it.
-  Not always appearing so direct and confident.

Personal Notes

Management

Creating the Ideal Environment

People are generally most effective when provided with an environment which suits their preferences and style. It can be uncomfortable to work in an environment which does not. This section should be used to ensure a close match between Sean's ideal environment and his current one and to identify any possible frustrations.

Sean's Ideal Environment is one in which:

-  Activities, variety and change are constantly taking place.
-  Direct and forthright communication is welcomed.
-  Numerical or technical data abounds.
-  There is little “traffic” or social interaction.
-  He has access to the fastest computers, where computers are used.
-  Ideas can be practically applied.
-  There is ample opportunity to express ideas.
-  He is given responsibility early on.
-  He has a position with status.
-  People around him are organised and consistent.

Personal Notes

Management

Managing Sean

This section identifies some of the most important strategies in managing Sean. Some of these needs can be met by Sean himself and some may be met by his colleagues or management. Go through this list to identify the most important current needs, and use it to build a personal management plan.

Sean needs:

-  An able, fast-paced backup team.
-  Options and alternatives before having to make decisions.
-  To be noticed.
-  Tasks which require thought, planning, but most of all action.
-  To be fully informed.
-  Time to adjust to other points of view.
-  To be allowed to call a spade a spade.
-  Established support systems and procedures.
-  The freedom to change out-dated rules.
-  The opportunity to think aloud.

Personal Notes

Management

Motivating Sean

It has often been said that it is not possible to motivate anyone - only to provide the environment in which they will motivate themselves. Here are some suggestions which can help to provide motivation for Sean. With his agreement, build the most important ones into his Performance Management System and Key Result Areas for maximum motivation.

Sean is motivated by:

-  Status, influence and prestige.
-  Being able to take control of situations.
-  Freedom from constraints and supervision.
-  Freedom to be forward looking.
-  Critical, analytical and logical dialogue.
-  A relentless drive to competency and effectiveness.
-  Having access to data and verifiable evidence.
-  A wide range of activities.
-  Setting stretching goals for himself and others to achieve.
-  “Pioneering” opportunities with little limitation.

Personal Notes

Management Style

There are many different approaches to management, most of which have different situational applications. This section identifies Sean's natural management approach and offers clues to his management style, highlighting both gifts and possible hindrances that can be further explored.

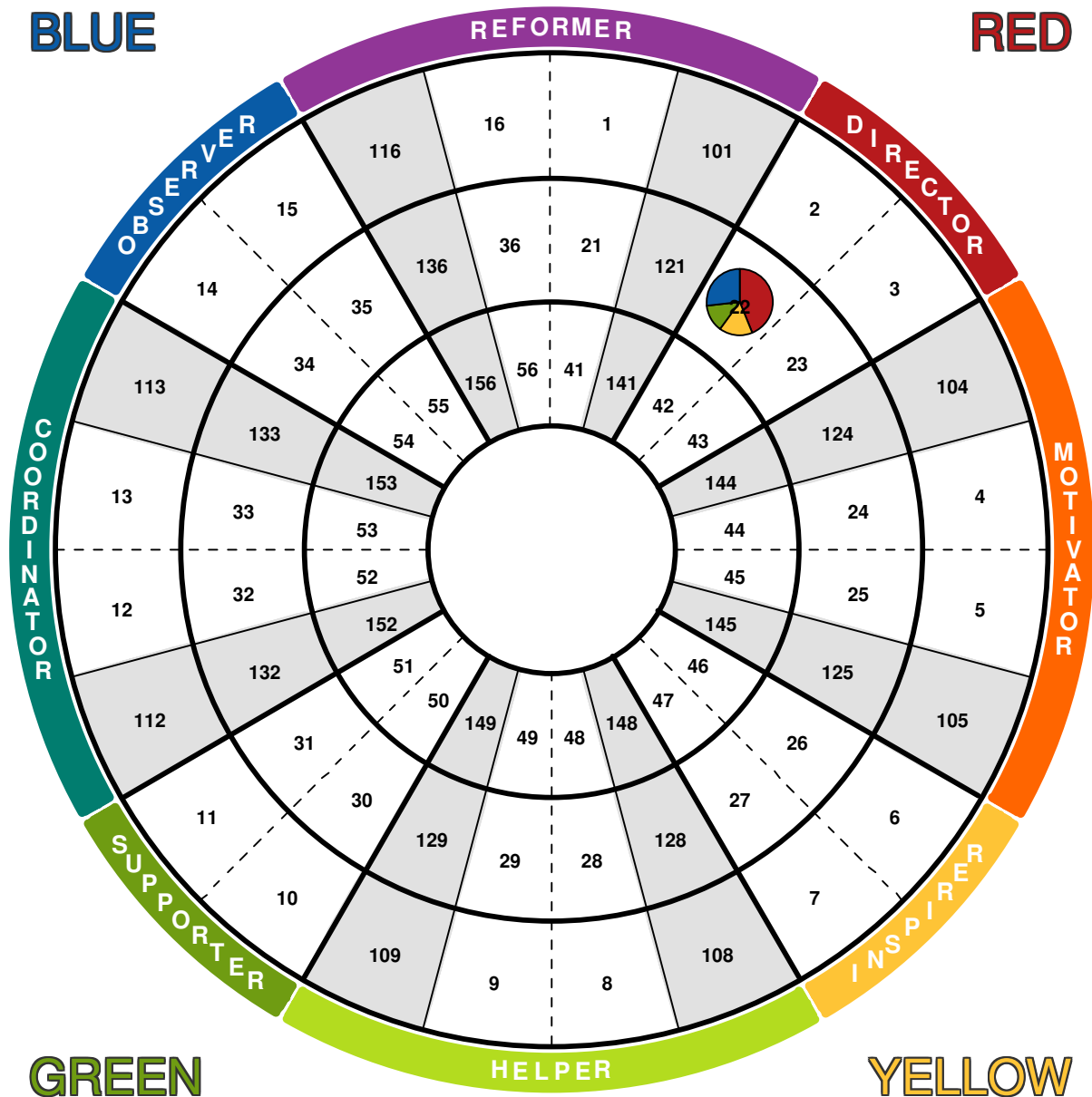
In managing others, Sean may tend to:

-  Disregard certain opinions and ideas which differ from his own.
-  Be unpredictable, short fused and inconsistent.
-  Appear to be less understanding of his colleagues' feelings.
-  Take on too much and over extend himself.
-  Encourage and push to achieve a high standard of performance.
-  Be passionate about his ideas.
-  Set rigid guidelines for completion of tasks.
-  Fail to listen actively to the views and opinions of others.
-  Ignore the feelings of those around him.
-  Always shoot for the goal.

Personal Notes

The Insights Wheel

Sean Porter
10/24/2014

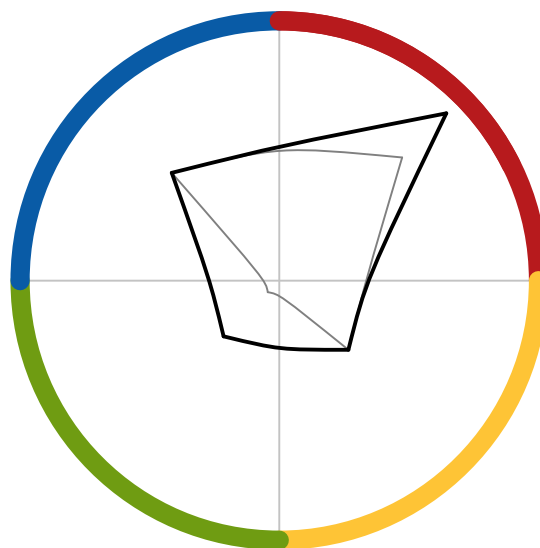
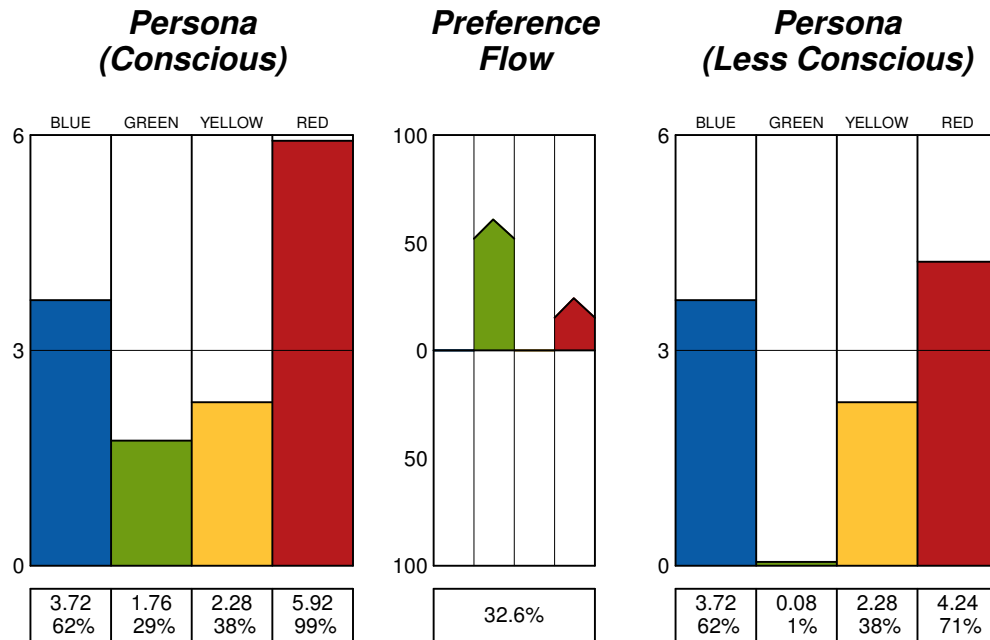


Conscious Wheel Position
22: Reforming Director (Classic)

Personal (Less Conscious) Wheel Position
22: Reforming Director (Classic)

Insights Colour Dynamics

Sean Porter
10/24/2014

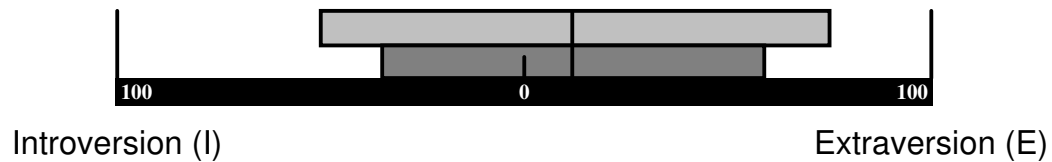


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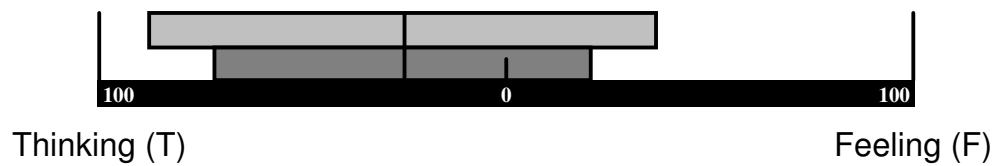
Jungian Preferences

Sean Porter
10/24/2014

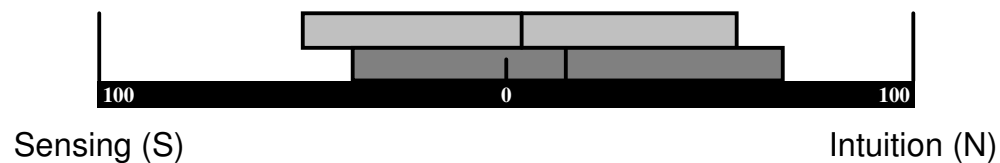
Attitude/Orientation:



Rational (Judging) Functions:



Irrational (Perceiving) Functions:



(Conscious)   (Less Conscious)